

English – Tetum glossary

Data analysis and interpretation terms used across Day 2 and Day 3.

Check this with a local colleague first

Please have a Tetum-speaking co-facilitator check this list before you print it. Tetum draws heavily on Portuguese for technical vocabulary, and usage varies between municipalities and between the Ministry of Health and academic settings. Where no settled Tetum term exists, the English or Portuguese term is commonly used directly — those rows are marked. Treat this as a starting point for your team, not an authority.

English	Tetum	Note
Data / dataset	Dadus	
Research	Peskiza	
Operational research	Peskiza operasionál	
Data analysis	Analiza dadus	
Result	Rezultadu	
Variable	Variavel	
Category / group	Kategoria / grupu	
Number	Numeru	
To count	Konta	
Total	Totál	
Percentage	Pursentu	
Denominator	Denominadór	Portuguese loan; often said in English
Numerator	Numeradór	Portuguese loan; often said in English
Mean / average	Média	
Median	Valór klaran	lit. 'middle value'; 'median' also widely used
Range	Intervalu	
Order / sequence	Ordem	
Table	Tabela	
Graph / chart	Grafiku	
Bar chart	Grafiku barra	
Line	Liña	
Column	Koluna	
Row	Liña	same word as 'line' — clarify from context
Title	Títulu	
Note / footnote	Nota	

English	Tetum	Note
Picture / image	Imajen	
To compare	Kompara	
To increase / decrease	Aumenta / hamenus	
High / low	Aas / kraik	
Far / near	Dook / besik	
Middle	Klaran	
Empty / blank	Mamuk	
Missing / not there	La iha	
Mistake / error	Sala	
To check / verify	Verifika	
To clean (data)	Hamoos dados	
Duplicate	Duplika	
To change	Muda	
Patient	Pasiente	
Treatment	Tratamentu	
Disease / illness	Moras	
Tuberculosis	Moras TB / tuberkuloze	
Age	Idade	
Sex (female / male)	Seksu (feto / mane)	
Municipality	Munisípiu	
Health facility	Fasilidade saúde	
Success	Susesu	
Died	Mate	
Lost / disappeared	Lakon	
Sample	Amostra	
Questionnaire	Kestionáriu	
Quality	Kualidade	
To explain	Esplika	
Meaning	Signifikadu	
Because of	Tanba	
Recommendation	Rekomendasaun	
Conclusion	Konkluziun	
Report	Relatóriu	

English	Tetum	Note
Who is responsible	Se mak responsavel	
Must change	Presiza muda	
Statistically significant	—	no settled Tetum term; explain in plain words instead
Confidence interval	—	used in English; explain as 'the range we are fairly sure about'

TIP

The last two rows matter most. **'Statistically significant' has no clean Tetum equivalent** — which is a gift, because it forces you to explain what you actually mean. If a participant cannot say their finding in Tetum without using an English statistics word, they probably have not understood it yet. Use that as a teaching test.